

When Leibniz says that the existence of “the individual things, or .. the entire collection and series of things” needs some explanation, which things is he thinking of?

The example of the geometry books gives us a clue. Is the existence of some geometry book contingent, or necessary?

This suggests an answer to our question. When Leibniz says that ‘the entire collection and series of things’ needs some explanation, he is talking about the entire series and collection of things whose existence is not metaphysically necessary – i.e., the collection of things which exist only contingently.

This gives a plausible candidate for a premise of Leibniz's argument:

The fact that there
are contingent things
has an explanation.



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR

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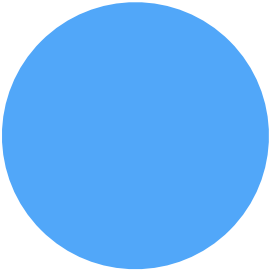
are continuing things

cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could

be Good.

Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

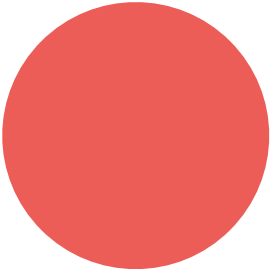






objections
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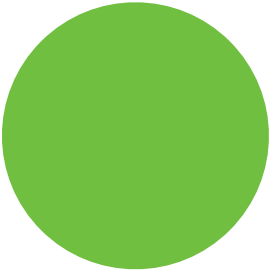




the
PSR







... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.



Leibniz's
argument

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are continuing to thrive